



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

AUGUST

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

**The deadline for September is
August 12**

Contributions may be brought to the
office or emailed to
office@minnehaha.org
**3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417**

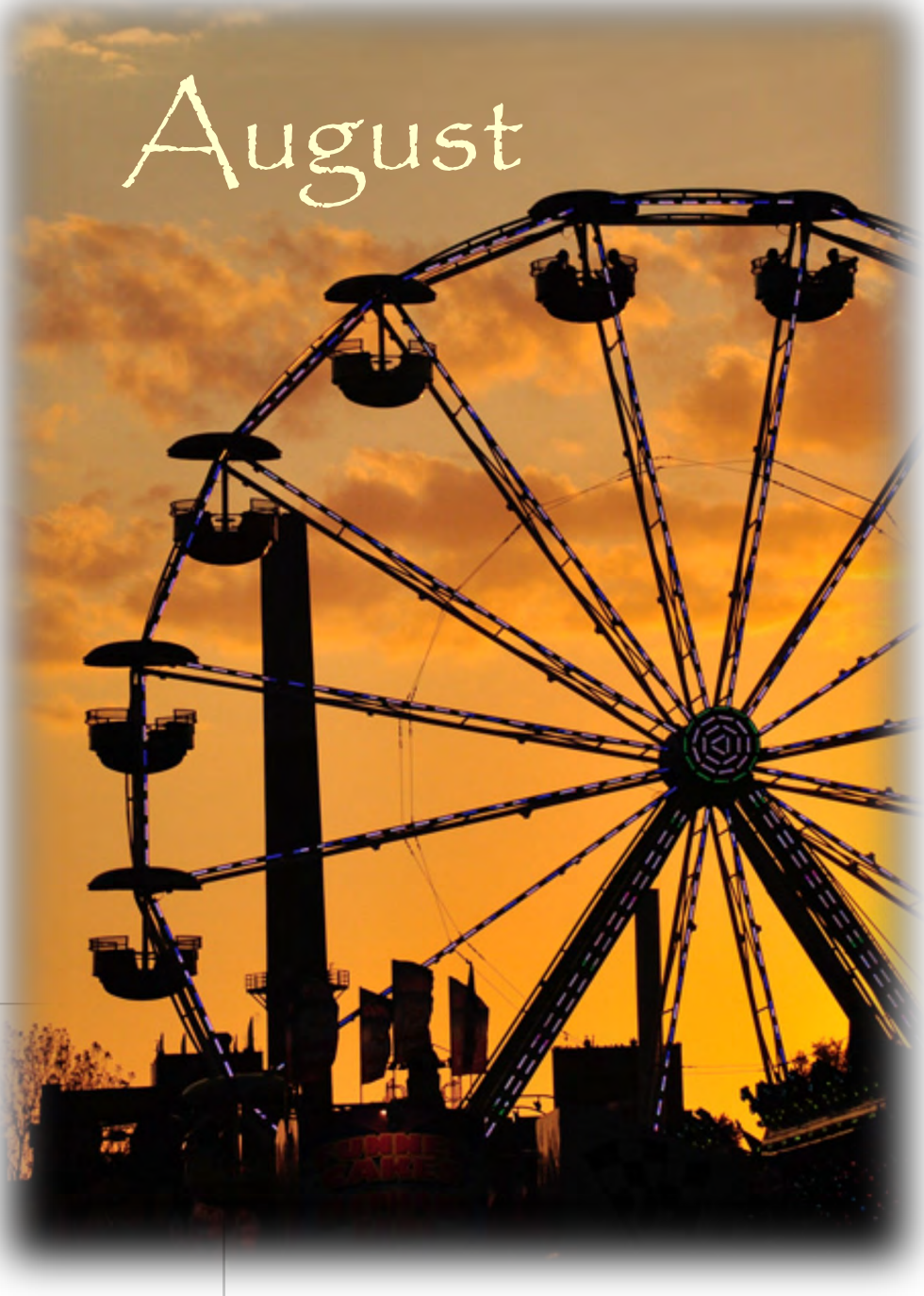
About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

August



SUMMER SUNDAY WORSHIP

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:30 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in August

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
	1 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 3:15p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p UMW Leadership	2 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	3 4p Methodicals 7p Children's Council	4 9a Fun & Fit 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 4p Brighter Minds Music	5 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a AI-Anon 6:30p RCA	6 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
7 International Friendship Day Communion 10:30a Worship at the Falls 6a Joy Catering 7p SAA	8 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 3:15p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Finance 6:30p Boy Scouts	9 Primary elections 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council	10 9:30a Mandala theatre visit 10a Staff Meeting 4p Methodicals	11 9a Fun & Fit 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 4p Brighter Minds Music	12 Newsletter items due 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a AI-Anon 6:30p RCA	13 International Left-Handers Day 8:45a Brighter Minds Music 1:30p Girl Scouts 6p NEBA Summer Concert
14 6a Joy Catering 9a Worship with Organ 10:30a Worship with Band 11:30a Media Training 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	15 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 3:15p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts 6:30p Women's Soul Group	16 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	17 4p Methodicals	18 9a Fun & Fit 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 4p Brighter Minds Music	19 9a Newsletter Collation 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a AI-Anon 6:30p RCA	20 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
21 Backpack Blessing 9a Worship with Organ 10:30a Worship with Band 7p SAA	22 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 3:15p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	23 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	24 4p Methodicals	25 9a Fun & Fit 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 4p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	26 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a AI-Anon 6:30p RCA	27 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
28 Animal Blessing 9a Worship with Organ 10:30a Worship with Band 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	29 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 3:15p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	30 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 12p Music Lesson 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 7p SPR	31 4p Methodicals 5:30p Welcome to Sunday School - Preschool Open House	Notes: To avoid conflicts, please check with Heather BEFORE scheduling any events.		

Worship in August

We begin the month at Minnehaha Falls Park with a worship service at the pavilion on August 7 at 10:30 a.m. with 4 of our neighbor congregations. Then our summer schedule of 9:00 indoors and 10:30 outdoors resumes for the rest of the month. August 21 will feature a blessing of bags and backpacks and August 28 is our annual blessing of animals at the 10:30 service. All animals are welcome, we just ask that they be on leash, in a bowl, or in some other kind of appropriate container. Last year's blessing included fish and a spider, so clearly all pets are welcome! Looking ahead, the first two Sundays in September will be one-service Sundays at 10:00 with the service being indoors on Labor Day weekend and outdoors on September 11, which is also the kick-off to our program year with a picnic and festival following the service.

7th *Worship at the Falls 10:30*

14th **"Signs of the Time"**

Luke 12:49-56

21st **"The Key to A Calm, Serene, Peaceful Life"**

John 14:1-3, 15-19, 25-27; Philippians 4:4-13

Greg Renstrom preaching on Brian Coyle

Blessing of all backpacks (personal and MinneHarvest) both services.

28th *Animal Blessing—Renee Beymer preaches*

Future Events at Minnehaha UMC—Save the Date

- August 7 10:30 Ecumenical Worship at Minnehaha Falls Park
- Sept. 4 10:00 One Service (Labor Day Weekend)
- Sept. 11 10:00 One service outside; Welcome Sunday
- Oct. 15 Harvest Dinner



COWBOY CHURCH ON JULY 10



School Supply Drive

It is that time of year again when the ads are coming out for school supplies. Even though it seems like the school year was just finished. Over the last few years the people of Minnehaha have had a great impact on the children of those families who attend the MinneHarvest by providing backpacks filled with school supplies to the children as they return to school in the fall. For the last several years we have helped over 160 children a year. Good things do truly happen here. Continuing this tradition is up to all of us

There are three ways to help with this mission

- ♦ Buy school supplies and bring them to church
- ♦ Designate an offering for school supplies in the Sunday offering
- ♦ Donate cash to be used for school supplies

Backpacks will be blessed on Sunday Aug 21 and handed out at the Aug 27th MinneHarvest.



Save the Date for Rally Day: Sunday, 11th September

Join with members of the Minnehaha United Methodist Church community as we celebrate the beginning of a new program year.

One Worship Service Outside at 10am

Followed by:

- **Meeting & Greeting Sunday School Teachers**
- **A bike parade and lawn games**
- **All-Church Lunch**

**Minnehaha United Methodist Church. We Seek. We Serve. We Celebrate.
3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis, MN 55417/612.721.6231/www.minnehaha.org**

Children's Ministries

With more than half of summer behind us, we know that the families of Minnehaha have been busy. We started the summer with Vacation Bible School and Music & Drama Camp, have been tending the garden, enjoying worship outside, sent kids to Trailblazers camp, and had Cowboy Sunday. It's been a full and good summer, juxtaposed, of course, with the events of the world that can overwhelm and frighten.

How does the work we do, the lives we lead, bring God's love to each and every person? How can we be certain that we are treating each person as our neighbor? How do we model these things for our children?

Throughout this next program year, we'll be doing our best to provide means for talking about these things, for supporting and brainstorming and working together to be the best possible community for our children we can be, and teaching them how they can be a part of this work. If you have any particular concerns or insights/talents you'd like to share with other parents and/or the children of Minnehaha, please contact Jenia Strom.

We wanted to share a bit with the community about the Trailblazers Camp that eight of our children attended at Camp Koronis in early July. The theme of the camp was "Fearless Faith." Throughout the week, as the children explored a wide range of traditional camp activities (boating, swimming, archery, wilderness survival, crafts, songs, campfire cooking, etc.), they also talked about how their faith gives them courage.

There were three main things they focused on in their morning devotions: the courage to show up, the courage to forgive, and the courage to change. All the kids had a wonderful time, and look forward to returning to camp next summer. Here are some of their thoughts:

Our favorite things about Trailblazers was the Wibbit, making new friends and sitting around the campfire and telling stories and singing songs, painting, and the counselors. We learned archery, boating, wilderness survival, how to make walking sticks, lots of silly songs, and always to forgive people.

Many thanks to all of you who contributed to our camping scholarships and for your prayers for the kids while they were at this camp. Keep Michael Talcott in your prayers when he heads to Northern Pines for Discovery Camp on August 7-9th. We'll be excited to hear what he has to report when he returns!

And, finally, it's not too early to be thinking about the program year. Registration is now available online at <https://form.jotform.com/Minnehaha/minnehaha---seeking-serving-and-cel>. (The link can be found on our website as well!)

Upcoming Dates:

Wednesday, August 24th at 5:30pm: End-of-Summer Celebration & Garden Party Potluck. Bring a summer dish to share, come to eat, visit, play, and garden!

Wednesday, August 31st from 5:30 to 7pm: Preschool Sunday School Open House - for all families with preschoolers (3 and 4 year olds) for the 2016-2017 Program Year. Come to learn about our Faith Formation program, see the classroom, and meet your teachers!

Sunday, September 11th - Rally Sunday! 10am worship, Sunday School Kick-off, Bicycle Parade, and an All-Church Lunch.

Please let me know if you have any questions or concerns!

Enjoy this last month of summer,

Jenia Strom

Director of Children and Family Ministries
education@minnehaha.org





Highlights from the June 14, 2016 Church Council Meeting

OIL TANK REMOVED: On June 2, the church's old, underground, unused oil tank was removed from the southeast corner of the building. It was a 3,800 gallon tank, which was about twice as large as was expected. There was NO LEAKAGE. As a result, funds set aside to cover possible soil contamination have already been used to pay back part of our building loan from Thrivent Financial. (Gene Thompson, Building and Grounds; Kim Kanuit, Trustees; Dennis Feller, Treasurer)

CHURCH FINANCES SOLID: In May, our revenues were a little higher than a normal month (since there are five Sundays in May and some larger donations came in) and expenses were a little lower (no large expenses for the month and utility costs were low). So we remain on track with our budget. All bills have been paid, including apportionments, through May 31, 2016. (Dennis Feller, Treasurer; Sue Claude, Finance Chair)

WEDNESDAY NIGHT SUPPERS A SUCCESS: The Council endorsed continuing Wednesday Night Suppers next year. The weekly 5:30 PM dinners provided a good opportunity for attendees, visitors and neighbors to get together and share a meal. The meals were good and they actually made a small profit. We do need a coordinator (with a job description) to make sure each week is covered. (Sarah Emrick, Children's Council)

FIRE DRILL A SUCCESS: Minnehaha UMC conducted a fire drill at 9:55 PM on June 12, at the end of the traditional worship service. The alarm system was operated by Dave Jorgenson of GB Tech. Thanks to all the volunteers who helped safely and efficiently evacuate the building within four minutes. (Gene Thompson, Building & Grounds; Dean Ammerman, Council Chair)

MUMC OPENS DOORS TO NAMI LISTENING TOUR: During the summer and fall of 2016, the Hennepin County affiliate of NAMI—a national organization dedicated to building better lives for the millions of Americans affected by mental illness—will hold its Second Annual Listening Tour. This is a series of 90-minute sessions designed to listen to what our community has to say about how our mental health system is (or is not) meeting the needs of our community. Minnehaha UMC will provide space for one of the sessions on the tour. (Maureen Trepp, United Methodist Women)

DO YOU HAVE AN OPINION ABOUT COFFEE HOUR? If you have an opinion about coffee hour—what's served, where it's located, how to make it better, etc.—talk to Dean Ammerman or Sarah Emrick.

MINNEHARVEST NEEDS YOUR SUPPORT: On the fourth Saturday of every month, Minnehaha UMC provides free food for anyone who needs it (no questions asked). Last month, 11,065 lbs. of food was given away to help feed 410 men, women and children. It costs the church \$475 per month to provide the food. Right now MinneHarvest is in a cash crunch. Please support this great mission with a donation and/or by volunteering on July 23, August 27, September 24, October 22 and November 26 starting at 6:45 AM; it normally wraps up around 10:30 AM. Note: If you can't make it early, come later for the clean-up! (Sheldon Bolstad, MinneHarvest coordinator)

HCI UPDATE: As we move forward with the Healthy Church Initiative (HCI), one idea that we may be trying out starting in September is to take an all-church spiritual journey centered around the book "We Make the Road by Walking" by Brian D. McLaren. This will be a 52-week "quest for spiritual formation, reorientation, and activation." Stay tuned for more on this. (Dean Ammerman, Council Chair)

from pg. 6

COMMUNITY ORGANIZING: The Council considered a request to distribute information and petitions on an issue that will come up in the 2016 November ballot. The Council felt that this type of program and/or petitioning would be best handled through the Nokomis East Neighborhood Association (NENA), with the church possibly making space available for meeting(s). (Dean Ammerman, Council Chair)

RALLY SUNDAY IS SEPT. 11: Rally Sunday is scheduled for Sunday, September 11. So be sure to put it on your calendar(s)!

NEXT MEETING AUGUST 9 AT 6:30 PM: The next Church Council meeting is scheduled for August 9 at 6:30 p.m. Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request.

—submitted by Dean Ammerman, Church Council Chair

Elections

Just a reminder that Tuesday, August 9 is the date of the primary elections. Not only is this an encouragement to vote, but it is a reminder that Minnehaha UMC is a polling place. You may have noticed that since it is a Tuesday, it is also a Food Shelf day. If you use Minnehaha as your polling place, just be aware that both events are happening at the same day; your patience and attitude of hospitality would be greatly appreciated.

**Minnehaha United Methodist Church
invites you
and your family
to our**

Faith Formation Open House

When: Wednesday, 31st August; 5:30-7pm

Where: Preschool Room (rm. 202) at Minnehaha

**Who: All Families with Preschool Age (3 & 4 year olds)
Children for the 2016-2017 Program Year**

**What: A chance to visit the Sunday School space and to
learn about our Faith Formation programs.**

**At Minnehaha, we strive to help children develop curiosity about
their faith, and to give them opportunities to seek, serve, and
celebrate God's love in an intergenerational and inclusive setting.**

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Questions? Contact Jenia Strom, Director of Children & Family Ministries, at education@minnehaha.org

You can
Seek, Serve, and Celebrate
while helping others to
Seek, Serve, and Celebrate

Join the Minnehaha Faith Formation Team!

The 2016-2017 program year kicks off on Sunday, September 11th, and continues through May. For us to have a successful program, we need volunteers.

We need volunteers of all ages, with openings in programs for all ages. We need people who'd like to commit on a weekly basis, and people who want to help out on limited, seasonal projects.

We need people who want to lead classes, and people who want to support those leaders.

We need the whole community.

Please consider how you might be a part of this team.

Name: _____

Email or Phone Number (however you prefer contact): _____

_____ Yes, I am interested. Please contact me to see how you can match my particular skills, interest, and availability with the needs of our Faith Formation program.

_____ Hmm, I am intrigued but not entirely certain. Please contact me to see if there's a way I might be able to help the team.

_____ Not this year. Please don't contact me.

Anything you'd like us to know ahead of time:

Adult Classes

On This Spirit Walk

A new 12-week class will begin on Monday evening, September 12 from 6:30-8:00. This study was created especially for United Methodists and was written by a Native American in collaboration with a member of the United Methodist Church who has worked extensively with Native American communities. We will be focusing on Native American tradition through our World Communion Sunday in October, and this is a wonderful opportunity to spend some time learning more about Native American spiritual culture and the connections to Christianity and to the United Methodism in particular. You will need to have the book *On This Spirit Walk* by Henrietta Mann & Anita Phillips for the class, so if you would like Becky to order it for you, please let her know prior to the first class. We will be reading a chapter each week (the chapters are short). You may also just go online (try Cokesbury.com where the book is sold for \$15) and order it yourself.

We Make the Road By Walking

We are trying a new thing this program year, encouraging the whole church to read a book together. It is meant to be read as a community, with questions for conversations among a household of all ages. To help us in this endeavor, we will also be discussing the chapter we are reading each week on Thursday mornings from 10-11. The books will be handed out during worship on Sunday, September 11 at our one service. If you aren't able to be in worship that day, talk to Becky to get your book in advance. Read the reflection for that week (they are all short), and come to class on Thursday morning for the conversation. This book will be our topic for December 15, and after Christmas, there will be a new study for the Thursday morning slot, and we'll make Monday evenings open for the continued conversation of our joint study.

Animal Blessing

Animals play an important role in many of our lives. If you have a special pet, we invite you to bring it to our annual animal blessing service on Sunday, August 28 at the 10:30 service (outside). We'll gather inside if it is raining, but either way, there will be a time in the worship service to have your pet blessed. Whether you have a horse or a hamster, you are welcome to bring your pet. Just make sure it's in a crate or container or on leash of some kind. If you don't have a pet, but wish you did, come anyway, and bring a stuffed animal if you'd like. If your pet doesn't like crowds, other animals, or can't really get out, bring a picture and we'll bless that. You may also wish to recognize the death of a pet in this way. And, invite your friends to bring their pets as well; we welcome everyone.

Blessing of Bags and Backpacks

We will be blessing bags and backpacks at our worship service on August 21. We are collecting back-to-school items for our MinneHarvest clients (see article elsewhere), and we want to give those backpacks a blessing in addition to any backpacks and bags of your own at the same time, so bring your back-to-school backpacks, your messenger bags, your purse, whatever you use to carry stuff, and we'll make sure it gets blessed!

Monthly Communion at Nokomis Square

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., Becky offers a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a conversation/study on some topic of interest. Anyone is welcome to come. This month we will be gathering on August 11.



Minnehaha Playdate
For Children 5 & Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

at
Minnehaha United Methodist Church

3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis 55417

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United
Methodist
Women

United Methodist Women

Do you know we have a second congregation who worships at our church? The Togolese community has services on Sunday evenings. Are you interested in finding out more about the country and culture of Togo? Please come to our evening meeting in September and join in on a conversation with Rev. Nicholas Sabah. We will be having a potluck dinner at 5:45 followed by this informative evening. Everyone is welcome to this UMW meeting. It will be on Thursday, Sept. 15 with the talk beginning at 6:30.

NAMI

NAMI of Hennepin County, part of an organization dedicated to building better lives for people affected by mental illness, will be holding a "Listening Session" in the Minnehaha UMC Fellowship Hall at 7:00 pm on Sept 22.

This listening session will be an opportunity for consumers of mental health services, family members and other interested parties to speak their minds regarding ways MH programs and services could be improved, as well as needs which are not being met.

A report on the 2015 Listening Tour can be viewed at www.namihennepin.org (click on "More").

Minnehaha's final garden party of the summer is approaching.

**Join us for an evening to celebrate the season,
to connect and reconnect, to dine, to play, to garden,
and to enjoy a summer evening together.**

When: Wednesday, August 24th

Where: The Side Yard of Minnehaha UMC

Who: All are welcome!

**What: Summer Potluck – Bring a dish to share!
(You're welcome to come beforehand to harvest
food from the garden to use in your dish!)**

**RSVP's are not required. We simply hope to see you there, and
encourage you to bring friends and family as well.**

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Note from the pastor



Good News

It has not been a summer of good news. I'd start a litany of all the horrible things that have happened in just the last couple of weeks, but it would be entirely too depressing, and who knows what more will happen after I finish writing. It's been truly awful. Even as I celebrated our niece's wedding and all

the wonderful things that happened (like her 96-year-old grandfather getting to attend, traveling outside his state for the first time in at least 15 years), we were all a little subdued by the events of the world.

A Minnesota summer beckons us to smile, but some days it seems a betrayal to the news for us to do so. A number of you have commented that you've just had to turn off the news, put down the paper, turn off your twitter feed or stop looking at Facebook in order to just take a breath.

We are way outside the season of Lent, but it feels like this is a good time to bring out a Lenten practice of giving up something or taking on something for a season. Despite all the news, we are still people of God. God's Spirit is still active in the world, and God is still a God of compassion and justice. So, give up the news when you need to, when you've heard enough that it's starting to turn your spirit sour and harden your heart. And, pick up the practice of thanksgiving. Find something in each day that makes you smile, and give thanks for it. In fact, find something in each hour. And, try reading the psalms. The psalms won't all be light and joyous, in fact some of them are downright depressing themselves. Others express the desire for revenge. But the psalms are a great reminder to us that this time is not unique. God's people have experienced heartache and devastation before. We have been in wars, we've been unjustly accused, we've witnessed the senseless loss of life. And the people of God have gone on. We have continued to believe, we have continued to hold out hope, we have continued to love God and to love our neighbors as ourselves. We have a heritage behind us, holding us up. The news may get worse before it gets better, but we can still find the good in each day and the presence of God in every spirit.

In joy and hope,

Becky





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8/16



Princeton & Symone Brown

***Sat. Aug 13th
6pm-8pm***

**A FREE Outdoor Reggae/Pop/R&B
Concert in the Nokomis Neighborhood!**

***Minnehaha United Methodist Church
3701 East 50th Street, Minneapolis***

Food, drinks, chair massage and great music. Come enjoy this festive neighborhood event! (If rain, concert will take place in the Fellowship Hall. Bring a donation for the Food Shelf and a lawn chair.)

Sponsored by NEBA (Nokomis East Business Assn),
Minnehaha United Methodist Church, Oxendale's,
Wendy's Doghouse, The Wellness Center, Brighter
Minds Music and Mandala Child Care.

www.nokomiseastba.com/events.html